Keliang Xiao

Department of Agricultural & Consumer Economics, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

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Education

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign — *Expected 2026*
Ph.D. in Agricultural and Applied Economics
Advisor: Prof. William Ridley
Graduate Minor in Statistics — *2024 - 2025*

Sun Yat-Sen University — *2018 - 2020*
M.A. in Applied Economics — *Guangdong, China*

Zhongnan University of Economics and Law — *2014 - 2018*
B.A. in Economics — *Hubei, China*

Research Interests

International Trade, Environmental Economics, Climate Change, Land Use

Working Papers

1. **Keliang Xiao**, William Ridley, and Doyoung Park. 2026. "Trade Policy and the Emissions Content of Agricultural Trade." Submitted to *Environmental and Resource Economics*.
2. **Keliang Xiao** and William Ridley. 2026. "The Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership and Its Implications for Global Trade." Submitted to *Review of World Economics*.
3. **Keliang Xiao**. 2026. "Palm Oil Trade, Tariff Exposure, and Deforestation in Indonesia." Working paper.

Work in Progress

1. **Keliang Xiao**. "Flood Risk Shocks, Flood Insurance, and Migration."
2. **Keliang Xiao**. "Carbon Trading Pilots in China: A Machine Learning Approach to Estimating Emission Effects."
3. Tiago Telles, Wander Plassa, Mary Arends-Kuenning, Shahadat Hossain, and **Keliang Xiao**. "Participation in Agricultural Cooperatives and the Adoption of Soil Conservation Practices among Farmers in Paraná."

Presentations

Oral Presentations

1. **Keliang Xiao**. "Palm Oil Trade, Tariff Exposure, and Deforestation in Indonesia." AAEA & WAEA Joint Annual Meeting, Denver, CO, 2025.
2. **Keliang Xiao**, William Ridley, and Doyoung Park. "Trade Policy and the Emissions Content of Agricultural Trade." AERE Summer Conference, Santa Ana Pueblo, NM, 2025.
3. **Keliang Xiao** and William Ridley. "The Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership and Its Implications for Global Trade." AAEA Annual Meeting, New Orleans, LA, 2024.

Poster Presentations

1. **Keliang Xiao**, William Ridley, and Doyoung Park. "Trade Policy and the Emissions Content of Agricultural Trade." AAEA & WAEA Joint Annual Meeting, Denver, CO, 2025.
2. **Keliang Xiao** and William Ridley. "The Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership and Its Implications for Global Trade." AAEA Annual Meeting, Washington D.C., 2023.

Teaching Experience

Instructor, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

Master's Math Camp *Summer 2025*

Responsibilities: Designed and taught an intensive mathematics camp, developed lectures and assignments on calculus, linear algebra, and probability to prepare incoming graduate students for advanced coursework.

Teaching Assistant, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

ACE 264: Applied Statistical Methods and Data Analytics II *Fall 2026*

Responsibilities: Facilitate lab sessions and evaluate student performance on labs and assignments for approximately 120 undergraduate students.

ACE 455: International Trade in Food and Agriculture *Fall 2023, 2024, 2025*

Responsibilities: Assessed assignments and exams and facilitated biweekly office hours to support students' learning, address course-related questions, and provide feedback on research paper progress.

Master's Math Camp *Summer 2023, 2024*

Responsibilities: Graded homework and provided targeted support during office hours to help students with diverse mathematical backgrounds prepare more effectively for master's-level study.

ACE 474: Economics of Consumption *Spring 2024*

Responsibilities: Facilitated in-class discussions and evaluated student performance through quizzes, assignments, and project presentations.

Awards and Honors

AAEA Travel Grants	AAEA, 2025
Spring Conference Travel Awards	University of Illinois, 2025
Summer Conference Travel Awards	University of Illinois, 2023, 2024
First-Class National Graduate Scholarship	Ministry of Education, China, 2019
Excellent Graduation Thesis Award	Zhongnan University of Economics and Law, 2018
Outstanding Student Scholarship (Grade 1)	Ministry of Education, China, 2015, 2016, 2017

Service and Leadership

Membership Director, Graduate Student Organization (GSO)
Department of Agricultural & Consumer Economics, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign, *2023 - 2024*
Session Moderator
Lightning Paper Session, AAEA & WAEA Joint Annual Meeting, Denver, CO, 2025

Additional Information

Programming and Software: Stata, R, Python, ArcGIS, LaTeX, Microsoft Office

Languages: English, Chinese (native)

Professional References

William Clifton Ridley, Ph.D.
Associate Professor
University of Illinois
Dept. of Agricultural & Consumer Economics
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Yilan Xu, Ph.D.
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University of Illinois
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Andrew B Hultgren, Ph.D.
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